



Video games are a powerful medium of communication. While we mostly think of them as tools for entertainment (which they are pretty awesome

at), they can be a lot more than just that. We already know that video games can be a great tool for teaching; we've written about those benefits more times than we can count. However, another great use for video games is spreading awareness and drawing attention to important matters. These are games for impact, games with deep messages, and life lessons. Games worth playing for not only the gameplay, but to enrich your lives. These aren't ranked, they're all pretty much worth picking up. So, let's get started with the list without beating around the bush too much!

That Dragon, Cancer

Indie developer Ryan Green's *That Dragon, Cancer* is a game about his son Joel and his four year battle with cancer. The game is the tale of him and his family's struggles as their son is diagnosed with a brain tumour under the age of one. The game is a roller coaster of emotions, aimed at emulating the journey that a family goes through when a loved one is diagnosed with a terminal disease. What makes *That Dragon, Cancer* hit even harder is the fact that Joel Green is still an infant who



has yet to develop even his basic motor skills. It's a heart wrenching game, but the game's message "Can you find hope in the face of death?", shines through in the end.

Life is Strange

Don't Nod's indie hit *Life is Strange* was lauded for its storytelling. But it also taught many important lessons. On the surface, *Life is Strange* comes across as a sci-fi teenage drama. The protagonist has the abil-



ity to turn back time. What would you do if you could turn back time? All those regrets, mistakes, embarrassing moments... Turning back time sounds pretty handy doesn't it? *Life is Strange* teaches us that even if you could, the alternative might not necessarily be better. Heck, it teaches us that there's no going back; the past is the past, you can't change it and that's something you need to come to terms with.

Undertale

2015's indie RPG hit *Undertale* took everyone by surprise with its unique approach to moral choices. The monsters of the underground fear humans, for obvious reasons, humans tend to want to kill them. However, it was possible to complete *Undertale* without any combat whatsoever. Kindness, diplomacy and mercy are your weapons and they work great! The game showed us that combat didn't always have to be the answer, conversation and persuasion could work just as well. If you take the time to get to know someone, even the brash ones could turn out to be

